

THE RIGHT **DASHCAM** FOR YOUR CAR

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A new digital transformation is coming soon to your car. Most of the mirrors will either be replaced or be upgraded with digital camera systems. Carmakers are already partnering with electronics companies to make this shift happen. Digital dashboard cameras, or dashcams, are already well-known to car owners. Not only do these devices give a clear picture of the surroundings, some also come equipped with smart features to keep you and your car(s) safe.

Essential features

A digital dashcam can be useful for a number of reasons, including road viewing, getting driving instructions, collision tracking or even receiving notifications against car theft. It is important to set up the dashcam in the position most appropriate for your purpose.

Cameras can be used on the front windshield to view the road ahead, inside the car to safeguard it when vacant, or at the back to help view what is going on behind, or to facilitate easier parking. You can also set up a multi-channel camera

system, but this a different area of discussion altogether.

After deciding the position of installation, the first selection criteria for a dashcam is its video and image quality. Go for a dashcam that supports a 1080p resolution video feed for clear visibility of onroad objects. Most dashcams today come with touchscreen facilities, which is an added advantage in terms of usage.

A dashcam with motion sensor, gravity sensor (or G-sensor) and motion-based auto-record facility can be highly useful. In case there is a moving subject or object at proximity, or occurrence of some incidence, the sensors can trigger the camera to start capturing images and videos, and to store these for future use.

To store necessary videos and images, it is important to choose a dashcam with sufficient storage facilities. Devices may come with internal storage or external SD card support. Some higher-priced models may even connect with the cloud directly. Go for a device with a high storage option.

Some of the smarter dashcams come with smart functions like inbuilt Wi-Fi and GPS with navigation tracking. These features can come in handy for real-time route detection, smooth file transfer and cloud connectivity on-the-go. However, opting for these features may lead to higher upfront cost.

Some dashcams are battery-powered, while others can either be hard-wired or charged through the power port of the car. You can opt for other features like night-vision and voice control, too.

Best dashcams in the market

There are many value-for-money options available in the market for you to choose from. You must ensure that the product you choose comes with a holder (that can be attached on the windshield) and is covered under a warranty of at least one year. We have mentioned a few of the recommendable options below. You may explore choices from other vendors too, based on your budget and requirements.

Blaupunkt BP 2.1. This budget-friendly offering from Blaupunkt can record full-HD videos (1080p) and display these on a 5.08cm (2-inch)



TFT screen. It has a 120-degree viewing angle. The battery-powered device has a G-sensor to record incidents automatically. Videos can be stored in an SD card (supports up to 32GB). The dashcam is available for ₹ 3300.

Procus Convoy. This dashcam has full-HD video resolution (1920p × 1080p) capacity with night-vision and a unique wide dynamic